



Figure 7: Working on Visual Studio online as Platform as a Service



Figure 8: Creating apps on the mobile engagement panel

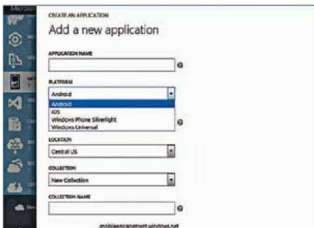


Figure 9: Selecting the type of mobile app on Azure



Figure 10: Creating Web apps using Joomla CMS



Figure 11: Specifying the database settings for Joomla on Azure



Figure 12: Creating an e-commerce application using OpenCart on MS Azure

As shown in Figure 8, there is the option to create and deploy mobile applications online using the cloud platform. This service is known as PaaS, as MS Azure is providing the complete platform to develop mobile applications on the cloud.

Azure can be used to create and deploy Web applications that are fully based on the CMS or e-commerce integrations. The content management system for developing Web apps is an integrated application that is used to create, deploy, manage and store content on Web pages.

Joomla is one of the key CMS platforms. It is written in PHP to enable building of websites and powerful online applications. Many aspects, including its ease-of-use and extensible nature, make Joomla the most popular Web based software development CMS. Joomla CMS is built on the model-view-controller (MVC) Web application framework, which can be used independent of the CMS.

Methods similar to Joomla's installation can be followed to install and deploy the OpenCart e-commerce platform. Using OpenCart, websites involving online financial transactions including online shopping, online bidding, payment gateways and related services, can be launched. OpenCart is pre-built in MS Azure; it can be installed in seconds and made ready for deployment. **END**

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